

Hello, I'm James

I'm a design leader who helps organisations build great in-house teams and digital services

James Cook

Bristol, United Kingdom

Work samples on request

Design Leader with 20+ years' experience delivering software systems, defining design practices, and developing people

hellojames.co.uk, [linkedin.com/in/hellojames](https://www.linkedin.com/in/hellojames), adplist.org/mentors/james-cook

Experience

User Experience Design Manager
2026–Pr • UK/DE/IN/PT • Springer Nature

Design Mentor
2021–Pr • Global

Lead Consultant
2022–24 • SG/AU • Thoughtworks

Design Operations Lead;
User Experience Practice Lead
2017–21 • UK • OVO Energy

User Experience Lead
2015–17 • UK/DE/IN • Springer Nature

Experience Design Senior Consultant;
Experience Design Consultant
2012–15 • UK/SG/IN • Thoughtworks

User Experience Designer
2011–12 • UK • Loco2 (now RailEurope)

User Experience Analyst
2008–10 • UK • Isotrak

Web Developer
2007–08 • UK • Cambridge Assessment

2006–07 **Cyfle/Sequence Digital**
2005–06 **Afanti Media**

Highlights

- Grew OVO's practice from 4→60+ and shaped teams, ways of working, and culture
- Established Springer Nature's global UX community and design operations
- Led Design for Singapore Government's first large-scale agile transformation
- Mentored 200+ people and interviewed 400+, building inclusive design teams
- Taught accessibility at UXThailand 2024 and Singapore GovTech Ally Week

Expertise

- Building and scaling design capability within large organisations
- UX strategy, design operations, and delivery assurance
- Cross-functional leadership across product, design, and engineering
- Leading research, content, and design in complex agile environments
- Embedding quality, accessibility, and scalability into software delivery

Strengths

- Helping product, design, and engineering work together more effectively
- Influencing prioritisation and trade-offs to align delivery with user needs
- Managing and growing designers, and sustaining communities of practice
- Hiring, team design, and defining effective ways of working
- Adapting approaches to problem spaces, and helping teams work better
- Collaboration, co-design, and iterative delivery across disciplines
- Facilitating workshops for alignment, inception, and shared understanding
- Analytical, structured thinking and pragmatic decision-making
- Rapid visual thinking to explore ideas and build shared ownership
- Framing solution direction, structure, and interaction design
- Guiding teams through organisational and industry change
- Enabling teams with servant leadership

Recognition

2024 & 2025 ADPList Top 100 Mentors
2019 OVO Values Heroes
2016 GovInsider Innovation Awards
2013 Google Global Impact Awards
2006 NESTA Innovate to Educate

Study

Design for Visual Communication PGC
University of the Arts London

Design for Interactive Media BA
University of Wales, Cardiff

Multimedia Product Design HND
Cardiff School of Art & Design

People before pixels.

Hello, I'm James

I've worked internationally
with a wide range of clients
across sectors

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SPRINGER NATURE

/thoughtworks

energy

SELFRIDGES&CO

**Singapore
Government**

nature

BMC

Springer

GOV•UK

SLC
Student Loans Company

**standard
chartered**

CAMBRIDGE
UNIVERSITY PRESS & ASSESSMENT

**AMNESTY
INTERNATIONAL**

I.LIBERTY

UXThailand

ADPlist

xero

janio

nti

HAWCROFT

RAIL•EUROPE

ISOTRAK

BT

Sequence

Labour

**Liberal
Democrats**

BBC

afanti